LIFE LIST

100 Michigan Bird Observations by County

= 3 Lifers

A "lifer" is the first bird of a species that you observe in your lifetime.

A "spark bird" is the bird observation which inspires one to start birding. Mine was a Red-wing Blackbird in Ionia County!

Washtenaw County

American Black Duck (*Anas rubripes*)
Mallard (*Anas platyrhynchos*)
Hooded Merganser (*Lophodytes cucullatus*)
Double-crested Cormorant (*Phalacrocorax auritus*)
Great Blue Heron (*Ardea herodias*)
Great Egret (*Ardea alba*)
Green Heron (*Butorides virescens*)
Osprey (*Pandion haliaetus*)
Cooper's Hawk (*Accipiter cooperii*)
Red-shouldered Hawk (*Buteo lineatus*)
Peregrine Falcon (*Falco peregrinus*)
Spotted Sandpiper (*Actitis macularius*)
Herring Gull (*Larus argentatus*)
Rock Pigeon (*Columba livia*)
Chimney Swift (*Chaetura pelagica*)
Belted Kingfisher (*Megaceryle alcyon*)
Downy Woodpecker (*Picoides pubescens*)
Northern Flicker (*Colaptes auratus*)
Yellow-throated Vireo (*Vireo flavifrons*)
Carolina Wren (*Thryothorus ludovicianus*)
Golden-crowned Kinglet (*Regulus satrapa*)
Cedar Waxwing (*Bombycilla cedrorum*)
Nashville Warbler (*Oreothylpis ruficapilla*)
Yellow Warbler (*Setophaga petechia*)
Common Yellowthroat (*Geothlypis trichas*)
Field Sparrow (Spizella pusilla)
Eastern Towhee (Pipilo erythrophthalmus)
Common Grackle (Quiscalus quiscula)
Brown-headed Cowbird (Molothrus ater)
Purple Finch (Haemorhous purpureus)
Chestnut-sided Warbler (Dendroica pensylvanica)

Ionia County

Cananda Goose (*Branta candensis*)
Mute Swan (*Cygnus olor*)
Wild Turkey (*Meleagris gallopavo*)
Turkey Vulture (*Cathartes aura*)
Red-tailed Hawk(*Buteo jamaicensis*)
Ring-billed Gull (*Larus delawarensis*)
Mourning Dove (*Zenaida macroura*)
Eastern Screech Owl (*Megascops asio*)
Red-headed Woodpecker (*Melanerpes erythrocephalus*)
Red-bellied Woodpecker (*Melanerpes carolinus*)
Pileated Woodpecker (*Dryocopus pileatus*)
Blue Jay (*Cyanocitta cristata*)
American Crow (*Corvus brachyrhynchos*)
Tree Swallow (*Tachycineta bicolor*)
Barn Swallow (*Hirundo rustica*)
Black-capped Chickadee (*Poecile atricapillus*)
Eastern Bluebird (*Sialia sialis*)
American Robin (*Turdus migratorius*)
European Starling (*Sturnes vulgaris*)
Dark-eyed Junco (*Junco hyemalis*)
Northern Cardinal (*Cardinalis cardinalis*)
Red-winged Blackbird (*Agelaius phoeniceus*)
House Finch (*Haemorhous mexicanus*)
House Sparrow (*Passer domesticus*)

Cheboygan County

Redhead (*Aythya americana*)
Common Merganser (*Mergus merganser*)
Red-breasted Merganser (*Mergus serrator*)
Common Loon (*Gavia immer*)
Piping Plover (*Charadrius melodus*)
Yellow-bellied Sapsucker (*Sphyrapicus varius*)
Eastern Wood-Pewee (*Contopus virens*)
Red-eyed Vireo (*Vireo olivaceus*)
Red-breasted Nuthatch (*Sitta canadensis*)
Gray Catbird (*Dumetella carolinensis*)
American Redstart (*Setophaga ruticilla*)
Black-throated Blue Warbler (*Dendroica caerulescens*)
Great Crested Flycatcher (*Myiarchus crinitus*)

Oakland County

Sandhill Crane (*Antigone canadensis*)
Hairy Woodpecker (*Picoides pubescens villosus*)
Eastern Phoebe (*Sayornis phoebe*)
Tufted Titmouse (*Baeolophus bicolor*)
White-breasted Nuthatch (*Sitta carolinensis*)
White-throated Sparrow (*Zonotrichia albicollis*)
Baltimore Oriole (*Icterus galbula*)

Bay County

Wood Duck (*Aix sponsa*)
Black-crowned Night Heron (*Nycticorax nycticorax*)
Caspian Tern (*Hydroprogne caspia*)
Eastern Kingbird (*Tyrannus tyrannus*)
Purple Martin (*Progne subis*)
Bank Swallow (*Riparia riparia*)

Barry County

Wood Thrush (*Hylocichla mustelina*)
Chipping Sparrow (*Spizella passerina*)
Song Sparrow (*Melospiza melodia*)
Rose-breasted Grosbeak (*Pheucticus ludovicianus*)
Indigo Bunting (*Passerina cyanea*)
American Goldfinch (*Spinus tristus*)

Crawford County

Kirtlands Warbler (*Setophaga kirtlandii*)
Common Nighthawk (*Chordeiles minor*)
Brown Thrasher (*Toxostoma rufum*)
Ovenbird (*Seiurus aurocapilla*)
Scarlet Tanager (*Piranga olivacea*)
Vesper Sparrow (*Pooecetes gramineus*)

Emmet County

Killdeer (*Charadrius vociferus*)
Common Tern (*Stern hirundo*)

Mackinac County

Golden Eagle (*Aquila chrysaetos*)
Nashville Warbler (*Leiothlypis ruficapilla*)

Allegan County

Bald Eagle (*Haliaeetus leucocephalus*)

Lapeer County

Ruby-throated hummingbird (*Archilochus colubris*)

County data from State of Michigan; Lakes and Streams from Esri Living Atlas; Observations and Cartography by Ashton Gibson, 2026.